Field Notes: The Salt Marsh Survey of 2025

The survey team, led by Dr. Rosalind Achterberg, sampled 48 plots along the Narrow River estuary between June 3 and August 29, 2025. Each plot measured 2 by 2 meters and was revisited every 14 days.

Spartina alterniflora covered 61% of the low marsh plots, down from 74% in the 2019 baseline. The decline was steepest in plots 12 through 19, where tidal flooding exceeded 330 hours per month.

Green crab density averaged 9.4 per square meter, nearly triple the 2019 figure of 3.2. Volunteers from the Wickford Garden Club logged 1,286 hours of fieldwork.

Recommendations: install 6 sediment elevation tables by May 2026, request $86,500 from the Coastal Resilience Fund, and repeat the survey in summer 2027.